

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called 'Beautiful of Bodily Form'

Ārya-rucirāṅgayaṣṭi-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 707 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ལས་ཀྱི་བུམ་མཇུག་པ་ཞེས་བརྒྱུན་གྲུབ་སྒྲུབ་པ།

Toh 707 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-rucirāṅgayaṣṭi-nāma-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as "The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Beautiful of Bodily Form." It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur, a class of texts centered on sacred formulas believed to confer protection, purification, and spiritual benefit upon those who recite or uphold them. This particular dhāraṇī is addressed to a luminous, jewel-crowned, lotus-bearing bodhisattva figure and invokes powers of dispelling darkness and negative rebirths, pacifying afflictions such as desire, hatred, and delusion, and bringing relief and fulfillment to all sentient beings. The text's opening syllables and extended mantra strings are characteristic of the genre, combining praise of the bodhisattva's radiant form with supplication for the liberation and consolation of all beings.

This completes the one hundred and eighth text, "The Jeweled Casket of Relics of All the Victors."

In the language of India: Ārya-rucirāṅgayaṣṭi-nāma-dhāraṇī. In the Tibetan language: The noble dhāraṇī called "Beautiful of Bodily Form."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Namo bipula bimana supratishthite asamkhyeya. Sūrya śata sahasra atirekata teja. Prabhā avabhāsita mūrtaye. Mahāmaṇi mukuṭa kuṇḍala. Alaṃkāra dhāriṇe bhagavate padmapāṇaye. Sarva loka apāya śamanāya. Vividha kuhaka samāvāśa aviṣṭha. Sarva sattva parimocakāya. Tadyathā. Oṃ bhūr bhuvaḥ svāhā. Mahā āloka karaṇa tamasa timira paṭala vināśaka. Rāga dveṣa mahā moha jvala śamaka. Śāsaka rakṣaka. Sarva apāya durgati praśamaka. Sarva sattvā samāśvāsanakara. Sarva āśā paripūraka. Sarva tathāgata saṃbhanakara. He he mahābodhisattva. Vara vara dāyaka. Padma āloka saṃbhr̥ta. Mahākāruṇika. Jaṭā mukuṭa. Alaṃkṛta śīrā. Maṇi kanaka rāja. Śata vajra vaiḍūrya alaṃkṛta śārīra. Amitābha jina kamala alaṃkṛta. Prābharaṇa rājana śata sahasra abhilaṣita kāya. Mahābodhisattva. Vidhama vidhama. Vināśaya vināśaya. Mahāyāntara kleśa kapaṭa. Avabaddha vibodhisattva saṃsāra caraka pramathāna. Puruṣa padma. Puruṣa nāga. Puruṣa sāgara. Puruṣa siṃha. Vaṃhi. Vira virāja. Sudānta pariprīta. Dhama dhama. Sama

sama. Dhuru dhuru. Praśāsaya praśāsaya. Pradhvaṃsāya pradhvaṃsāya. Ghiri ghiri. Dhiri dhiri. Vidhiri vidhiri. Viri viri. Viviri viviri. Ciri ciri. Siri siri. Suru suru. Muru muru. Muya muya. Muñca muñca. Dhuna dhuna. Vidhuna vidhuna. Dhuru dhuru. Ghaya ghaya. Ghādhaya ghādhaya. Hasa hasa. Prahasa prahasa. Nānā vidha kleśa vāsanā. Hara hara. Saṃhara saṃhara. Dhuruti dhuruti. Mahāmaṇḍala alaṃkāraṇa. Śata prāseka. Avabhāsita mahāviṣa śamaka. Mahābodhisattva vara dāya svāhā.

This is the dhāraṇī called "Beautiful of Bodily Form," belonging to the Blessed One Padmapāṇi (the Lotus-Holder, that is, Avalokiteśvara). It is the sublime palace of the bodhisattva, proclaimed as a protection by the Great Vajra, praised by gods, nāgas, the sons of the yakṣas, kinnaras, and the great asuras, and it fulfills all wishes to perfection.

For any person obscured by many heavy obscurations who hears this dhāraṇī, retains it, recites it, reads it, or upon seeing it comes to understand it well, all the obscurations of karma and mental afflictions of that person will be completely purified. If one rises in the morning and recites it once, Padmapāṇi will follow closely behind, like a shadow. Whatever purposes and aims one holds in mind will be accomplished by that very thought alone.

If one sits alone in complete solitude, clearly visualizing a buddha in mind, recalling the Blessed One Padmapāṇi, and recites this seven times, one will obtain whatever is most excellent that one wishes. All sentient beings will be drawn to one with affection. All one's lower rebirths will be entirely cut off. Even if one recites it mentally while simply walking or sitting, the karma accumulated over countless tens of millions of eons will be purified. One will come to possess a great mass of merit equal to that accumulated by a thousand wheel-turning sovereigns. Life after life, one will be born into the great lotus lineage. One will be honored by exceptional persons.

If one fills one's cupped hands with fragrant flowers, stands before the noble Avalokiteśvara, Lord of Compassionate Sight, and recites this seven times, one will obtain a thousand great qualities.

The nature of reality of great compassion will itself arise as luminous appearance, and one will come to possess the Great Supreme.

If one gazes directly at that image and recites the dhāraṇī, one will behold the Blessed One, the noble Avalokiteśvara, Lord of Compassionate Sight, whose countenance is ever smiling, and one will obtain what is called "the primary luminous clarity of Dharmic appearance, free from defilement."

In this very lifetime one will attain the recollection of the buddhas. One will die with the mind in meditative equipoise. In every future life, one will remember all one's past lives.

If one wishes to exhaust all karmic obscurations entirely as one desires, one should fast on the full-moon day of the fifteenth, clothe oneself in white garments, and before a stūpa containing relics or before a sacred image, draw a maṇḍala with white sandalwood paste. One should scatter varied flowers upon that maṇḍala and upon the Blessed One, offer fragrant incense, butter lamps, and aromatic resins to the Blessed One and to the noble Avalokiteśvara, Lord of Compassionate Sight, remain seated in that very place, and recite one hundred and eight times. By this, one will be freed from all misdeeds. Even one who has committed the acts without interval will be purified of misdeeds, and will come to possess a mental continuum that is utterly and completely pure, as well as utterly and completely pure conduct of body, speech, and mind.

The Tathāgatas will constantly and without interruption work to establish for that person the power of meditative absorption, the power of empowerment, the power of the grounds and perfections, and the power of exceptional primordial wisdom.

If one gazes upward toward the sky and recites the dhāraṇī, rain will fall. If one gazes down at the ground and recites it, all crops will flourish. If one gazes at the courses of streams, small lakes, and ponds and recites it, water will spring forth. If one strokes all manner of illness with one's hand while reciting it, healing will result. If one recites it in the presence of someone whose memory has failed, their memory will be restored. If one gazes upon the face of one who is hungry or thirsty and recites it, their hunger and thirst will be appeased. If a great pestilence arises, one should write the dhāraṇī on cloth and affix it to the tip of a victory banner; this will cut off and protect against harm within the surrounding area up to one league in extent.

Here ends the dhāraṇī called "The Noble One of Beautiful Bodily Form."

Translator's Notes

- The bulk of this passage consists of dhāraṇī mantra syllables transliterated into Tibetan script from Sanskrit. These are rendered here in reconstructed Sanskrit phonetic form following standard convention for dhāraṇī texts; they are not translated, as dhāraṇīs are understood within the tradition as efficacious sonic formulas whose power does not depend on semantic parsing of each syllable.

The phrase rendered "the sons of the yakṣas" translates a term that in context refers to the offspring of yakṣinīs or the class of beings associated with yakṣas; some commentators read this differently.

- The phrase rendered "acts without interval" refers to the five heinous crimes of immediate retribution (ānantarya-karma), the gravest category of misdeeds in Buddhist soteriology. Rendering "ཡེ་ཤེས་ཀྱི་ལྷན་པོ་" as "one who has committed the acts without interval" preserves this technical meaning.

The phrase "འཇིག་རྟེན་གྱི་ལྷན་པོ་" is a proper name or title of a meditative or cognitive attainment; it is rendered literally as a quoted title in the translation. Its exact doctrinal referent in this text is not specified by the immediate context.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.